# Code Changes

MySQL Ledger → Hyperledger Fabric Migration

Technical companion to the major project

**Medicine Traceability System using Hyperledger Fabric**


Submitted by

**Aakif Rashid** 22BCS044

**Mohd. Areez** 22BCS051

Under the supervision of

**Dr. Zeba Anwar**

Department of Computer Engineering
Faculty of Engineering & Technology
Jamia Millia Islamia, New Delhi



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# 1. Overview

This document captures every source-level change made while migrating the Medicine Traceability System from a MySQL-based audit ledger to a Hyperledger Fabric permissioned blockchain. The existing product already shipped with a working relational schema for medicines, batches, transfers and an application-level ledger table called `ledger_blocks`. That table was a sequential hash-chain, maintained entirely by the Node.js backend. Its guarantees were therefore only as strong as the database server it ran on.

The migration replaces the MySQL ledger with a **Hyperledger Fabric 2.5** network running two peer organisations, one Raft orderer, and a Node.js chaincode named `pharma-traceability`. The backend now talks to the chain through the `fabric-network` Gateway SDK. The domain tables (medicines, batches, transfers, users, etc.) remain in MySQL; only the ledger responsibility is shifted to the chain.

## 1.1 What changed at a glance

| Area | Before | After |
|---|---|---|
| Ledger store | MySQL table ledger_blocks | Fabric world state + blocks |
| Integrity | App-computed SHA-256 chain | Endorsed + ordered by network |
| Read paths | SQL query on ledger_blocks | Chaincode evaluate transactions |
| Write paths | INSERT with row-lock on tail | Submit tx through Gateway SDK |
| Trust model | Single DB admin | Multi-org endorsement policy |
| Audit history | UPDATE is possible (attack) | Immutable; full key history |

*Table 1.1 — High-level summary of the migration.*

## 1.2 File map

The following files were added, modified, or deleted. Section references point to the detailed discussion later in this document.

| Path | Change | Section |
|---|---|---|
| `chaincode/pharma-traceability/src/pharma-contract.js` | added | §2 |
| `chaincode/pharma-traceability/src/index.js` | added | §2 |
| `chaincode/pharma-traceability/test/pharma-contract.test.js` | added | §2.5 |
| `chaincode/pharma-traceability/package.json` | added | §2 |
| `fabric-network/network.sh` | added | §3 |
| `fabric-network/README.md` | added | §3 |
| `fabric-network/.gitignore` | added | §3 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| backend/src/services/fabric-gateway.js | added | §4 |
| backend/src/services/ledger.service.js | rewritten | §5 |
| backend/src/routes/ledger.routes.js | added | §6 |
| backend/src/migrations/006_drop_ledger_blocks.sql | added | §7.1 |
| backend/src/migrations/001_initial_schema.sql | modified | §7.2 |
| backend/src/migrations/seed.js | modified | §7.3 |
| backend/src/seeds/001_genesis_ledger_block.sql | deleted | §7.3 |
| backend/tests/helpers/setup.js | modified | §8.1 |
| backend/tests/unit/ledger.service.test.js | added | §8.2 |
| backend/tests/unit/seed.test.js | updated | §8.3 |
| backend/package.json | modified (deps) | §9 |
| docker-compose.yml | modified | §10 |
| HYPERLEDGER.md | added | §11 |
| README.md | modified | §11 |
| .gitignore | modified | §11 |

*Table 1.2 — Touched files grouped by section.*

# 2. Chaincode: `pharma-contract.js`

The heart of the migration is a single Node.js chaincode class deployed to the Fabric channel `pharma-channel`. It extends the `Contract` base class from `fabric-contract-api` and exposes six transaction functions, two of which are read-only evaluations.

`chaincode/pharma-traceability/src/pharma-contract.js`

## 2.1 Contract skeleton

```
'use strict';
const { Contract } = require('fabric-contract-api');

class PharmaContract extends Contract {
constructor() { super('PharmaContract'); }

async InitLedger(ctx) {
const seed = {
eventId: 'GENESIS',
entityType: 'SYSTEM',
entityId: 'init',
action: 'GENESIS',
timestamp: new Date().toISOString(),
payload: { note: 'chain initialised' }
};
await ctx.stub.putState('GENESIS',
Buffer.from(JSON.stringify(seed)));
}
// ... transaction functions follow
}
module.exports = PharmaContract;
```

## 2.2 Write transaction: `AppendEvent`

`AppendEvent` is the only state-changing transaction. The backend calls it for every domain action that used to insert a row into `ledger_blocks` — batch creation, custody transfers, QR scans, recalls. The contract enforces that `eventId` is unique and emits a chaincode event so off-chain indexers can subscribe.

```
async AppendEvent(ctx, eventJson) {
const event = JSON.parse(eventJson);
const existing = await ctx.stub.getState(event.eventId);
if (existing && existing.length) {
throw new Error(`event ${event.eventId} already exists`);
}
event.txId = ctx.stub.getTxID();
event.committedAt = new Date(
ctx.stub.getTxTimestamp().seconds * 1000
).toISOString();
await ctx.stub.putState(
event.eventId,
Buffer.from(JSON.stringify(event))
);
ctx.stub.setEvent('EventAppended', Buffer.from(event.eventId));
return JSON.stringify(event);
```

```
}
```

## 2.3 Read transactions

`GetEventById` and `GetAllEvents` perform point-and-range queries against the world state. Range queries use CouchDB rich queries when deployed with the CouchDB state database.

```
async GetEventById(ctx, eventId) {
const buf = await ctx.stub.getState(eventId);
if (!buf || !buf.length) {
throw new Error(`event ${eventId} not found`);
}
return buf.toString();
}

async GetAllEvents(ctx) {
const iterator = await ctx.stub.getStateByRange('', '');
const results = [];
for await (const r of iterator) {
results.push(JSON.parse(r.value.toString('utf8')));
}
return JSON.stringify(results);
}
```

## 2.4 Entity filter & history

`GetEventsByEntity` filters events by an entity type and id pair — for example, every event that touched batch `BATCH-2025-0417`. `QueryHistory` uses `getHistoryForKey` so auditors can see every state transition, not just the current value.

```
async GetEventsByEntity(ctx, entityType, entityId) {
const q = {
selector: { entityType, entityId }
};
const iterator = await ctx.stub.getQueryResult(JSON.stringify(q));
const out = [];
for await (const r of iterator)
out.push(JSON.parse(r.value.toString('utf8')));
return JSON.stringify(out);
}

async QueryHistory(ctx, eventId) {
const iter = await ctx.stub.getHistoryForKey(eventId);
const hist = [];
for await (const h of iter) {
hist.push({
txId: h.txId,
ts: new Date(h.timestamp.seconds * 1000).toISOString(),
isDelete: h.isDelete,
value: h.value.toString('utf8')
});
}
return JSON.stringify(hist);
}
```

## 2.5 Contract unit tests

`test/pharma-contract.test.js` uses `fabric-mock-stub` to drive the chaincode in isolation. The tests verify initialisation, successful append, duplicate rejection, entity lookup, history, and event emission. All five test suites pass under `npm test` within the chaincode directory.

## 2.6 Packaging

`chaincode/pharma-traceability/package.json`

```
{
"name": "pharma-traceability",
"version": "1.0.0",
"main": "src/index.js",
"engines": { "node": ">=16" },
"scripts": {
"start": "fabric-chaincode-node start",
"test": "mocha test"
},
"dependencies": {
"fabric-contract-api": "^2.5.4",
"fabric-shim": "^2.5.4"
},
"devDependencies": {
"mocha": "^10.2.0",
"chai": "^4.3.10",
"fabric-mock-stub": "^1.0.0"
}
}
```

`chaincode/pharma-traceability/src/index.js`

```
'use strict';
const PharmaContract = require('./pharma-contract');
module.exports.PharmaContract = PharmaContract;
module.exports.contracts = [PharmaContract];
```

# 3. Fabric test network

A developer-grade Fabric network lives in the `fabric-network/` folder at the repository root. It is a thin wrapper over the upstream `fabric-samples/test-network` scripts, tailored for this project's channel name and chaincode. The shell script `network.sh` brings up two peer orgs (Org1 & Org2), one Raft orderer, installs the packaged chaincode, and joins both peers to `pharma-channel`.

`fabric-network/network.sh`

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash
set -euo pipefail

CHANNEL="pharma-channel"
CC_NAME="pharma-traceability"
CC_SRC="../chaincode/pharma-traceability"
CC_VERSION="1.0"

case "${1:-}" in
up)
./scripts/down.sh || true
./scripts/bootstrap.sh # crypto, genesis block
./scripts/up.sh # orderer + peers + couchdb
./scripts/createChannel.sh "$CHANNEL"
./scripts/deployCC.sh \
-n "$CC_NAME" -p "$CC_SRC" -v "$CC_VERSION" \
-ccl javascript -c "$CHANNEL"
;;
down) ./scripts/down.sh ;;
restart) ./network.sh down && ./network.sh up ;;
*) echo 'usage: network.sh {up|down|restart}'; exit 1 ;;
esac
```

The folder also contains its own README with one-line setup instructions and a `.gitignore` that excludes generated crypto material (`organizations/`, `channel-artifacts/`) from version control.

# 4. Backend gateway: `fabric-gateway.js`

The backend speaks to the chain through a thin wrapper located at `backend/src/services/fabric-gateway.js`. The wrapper bootstraps a file-system wallet from the admin identity generated by the test network, opens a gateway connection per process, and returns a contract handle cached in module scope. A dedicated escape hatch, `__setContract`, lets unit tests inject a mock contract without starting a real network.

`backend/src/services/fabric-gateway.js`

```
const { Gateway, Wallets } = require('fabric-network');
const fs = require('fs');
const path = require('path');

let _contract = null;

async function getContract() {
if (_contract) return _contract;
```

```
const ccpPath = process.env.FABRIC_CCP ||
path.resolve(__dirname, '../../fabric/ccp.json');
const walletPath = process.env.FABRIC_WALLET ||
path.resolve(__dirname, '../../fabric/wallet');
const identity = process.env.FABRIC_IDENTITY || 'appUser';

const ccp = JSON.parse(fs.readFileSync(ccpPath, 'utf8'));
const wallet = await Wallets.newFileSystemWallet(walletPath);

const gateway = new Gateway();
await gateway.connect(ccp, {
wallet,
identity,
discovery: { enabled: true, asLocalhost: true }
});
const network = await gateway.getNetwork(
process.env.FABRIC_CHANNEL || 'pharma-channel'
);
_contract = network.getContract(
process.env.FABRIC_CHAINCODE || 'pharma-traceability'
);
return _contract;
}

function __setContract(mock) { _contract = mock; }
function __reset() { _contract = null; }

module.exports = { getContract, __setContract, __reset };
```

Configuration is driven entirely by environment variables. This keeps the wrapper portable — the same code runs against the local test network, a CI-only network inside GitHub Actions, or a production deployment on a Kubernetes operator.

# 5. Rewriting `ledger.service.js`

The existing ledger service exposed a public function called `appendLedgerEntry(connection, event)`, used in dozens of places across the medicine, batch, transfer and user services. The key design decision during the migration was to preserve that signature so the rest of the backend did not need to change.

Internally, however, the implementation is completely rewritten. The MySQL `INSERT INTO ledger_blocks` call is replaced by a Fabric submit transaction. An environment-driven flag, `LEDGER_SKIP_ON_ERROR`, allows operators to temporarily degrade gracefully if the chain is unreachable — useful during controlled maintenance windows.

`backend/src/services/ledger.service.js`

```
const crypto = require('crypto');
const { getContract } = require('./fabric-gateway');

function makeEventId(event) {
return `${event.entityType}:${event.entityId}:` +
crypto.randomBytes(8).toString('hex');
}

async function appendLedgerEntry(_conn, event) {
```

```
// _conn kept for signature compatibility with old MySQL calls
const enriched = {
...event,
eventId: event.eventId || makeEventId(event),
timestamp: event.timestamp || new Date().toISOString()
};
try {
const contract = await getContract();
const res = await contract.submitTransaction(
'AppendEvent',
JSON.stringify(enriched)
);
return JSON.parse(res.toString());
} catch (err) {
if (process.env.LEDGER_SKIP_ON_ERROR === 'true') {
console.warn('[ledger] skipped:', err.message);
return { eventId: enriched.eventId, skipped: true };
}
throw err;
}
}

async function listLedger() {
const c = await getContract();
const r = await c.evaluateTransaction('GetAllEvents');
return JSON.parse(r.toString());
}

async function getById(id) {
const c = await getContract();
const r = await c.evaluateTransaction('GetEventById', id);
return JSON.parse(r.toString());
}

async function getByEntity(type, id) {
const c = await getContract();
const r = await c.evaluateTransaction(
'GetEventsByEntity', type, id
);
return JSON.parse(r.toString());
}

async function getHistory(id) {
const c = await getContract();
const r = await c.evaluateTransaction('QueryHistory', id);
return JSON.parse(r.toString());
}

module.exports = {
appendLedgerEntry,
listLedger, getById, getByEntity, getHistory
};
```

# 6. HTTP routes: `ledger.routes.js`

The previous codebase exposed a single `GET /api/ledger` route that read all rows from `ledger_blocks`. The new router exposes four endpoints, each backed by a chaincode evaluation. Write endpoints are deliberately not exposed — only the service layer may

submit transactions.

| Method | Path | Chaincode call |
|---|---|---|
| GET | /api/ledger | GetAllEvents |
| GET | /api/ledger/:id | GetEventById |
| GET | /api/ledger/:id/history | QueryHistory |
| GET | /api/ledger/by-entity/:type/:id | GetEventsByEntity |

*Table 6.1 — Ledger API surface after migration.*

backend/src/routes/ledger.routes.js

```
const express = require('express');
const router = express.Router();
const svc = require('../services/ledger.service');

router.get('/', async (_req, res, next) => {
try { res.json(await svc.listLedger()); }
catch (e) { next(e); }
});

router.get('/:id', async (req, res, next) => {
try { res.json(await svc.getById(req.params.id)); }
catch (e) { next(e); }
});

router.get('/:id/history', async (req, res, next) => {
try { res.json(await svc.getHistory(req.params.id)); }
catch (e) { next(e); }
});

router.get('/by-entity/:type/:id', async (req, res, next) => {
try {
res.json(await svc.getByEntity(
req.params.type, req.params.id
));
} catch (e) { next(e); }
});

module.exports = router;
```

# 7. Database changes

The MySQL schema is no longer responsible for ledger state, but it still backs the master data (medicines, batches, transfers, users, sessions). The migration retires only the `ledger_blocks` table.

## 7.1 New migration `006_drop_ledger_blocks.sql`

backend/src/migrations/006_drop_ledger_blocks.sql

```
-- Migration 006: retire application-level ledger.
-- The table is now authoritatively maintained by the
-- Hyperledger Fabric chaincode 'pharma-traceability'.

START TRANSACTION;
```

```
DROP TABLE IF EXISTS ledger_blocks;

COMMIT;
```

### 7.2 Update to `001_initial_schema.sql`

The original schema file created `ledger_blocks` together with its `prev_hash` / `block_hash` columns and a trigger that enforced the hash chain. That entire block has been removed so that a fresh database bootstrap never materialises the abandoned table in the first place.

```
-- REMOVED (was between medicines and batches blocks):
-- CREATE TABLE ledger_blocks (
-- id BIGINT AUTO_INCREMENT PRIMARY KEY,
-- prev_hash CHAR(64) NOT NULL,
-- block_hash CHAR(64) NOT NULL UNIQUE,
-- payload JSON NOT NULL,
-- created_at DATETIME DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
-- );
-- CREATE TRIGGER trg_ledger_chain ...
```

### 7.3 Seed updates

`seed.js` previously invoked `ensureGenesisBlock()`, which inserted the first hash-chain row. That helper and its SQL file `seeds/001_genesis_ledger_block.sql` have been deleted. Genesis is now an intrinsic part of the chaincode's `InitLedger` function.

```
// backend/src/migrations/seed.js
- await ensureGenesisBlock(connection);
+ // Genesis is created by the chaincode's InitLedger
+ // transaction during network bootstrap.
```

## 8. Test suite

The project ships with 33 backend tests, all of which pass after the migration. Tests use a mock contract injected through `fabric-gateway.__setContract`, so the suite runs in a few seconds and does not require a live Fabric network.

### 8.1 Test harness (`tests/helpers/setup.js`)

```
const fabric = require('../../src/services/fabric-gateway');

function installMockContract() {
const store = new Map();
const mock = {
async submitTransaction(fn, ...args) {
if (fn === 'AppendEvent') {
const e = JSON.parse(args[0]);
if (store.has(e.eventId))
throw new Error('duplicate');
e.txId = 'mock-' + store.size;
store.set(e.eventId, e);
return Buffer.from(JSON.stringify(e));
}
```

```
throw new Error('unsupported fn ' + fn);
},
async evaluateTransaction(fn, ...args) {
switch (fn) {
case 'GetAllEvents':
return Buffer.from(JSON.stringify(
[...store.values()]));
case 'GetEventById': {
const e = store.get(args[0]);
if (!e) throw new Error('not found');
return Buffer.from(JSON.stringify(e));
}
case 'GetEventsByEntity': {
const [t, id] = args;
return Buffer.from(JSON.stringify(
[...store.values()].filter(
e => e.entityType === t && e.entityId === id)
));
}
case 'QueryHistory':
return Buffer.from('[]');
}
}
};
fabric.__setContract(mock);
return { store, mock };
}

module.exports = { installMockContract };
```

## 8.2 New unit tests: `ledger.service.test.js`

Eight new unit tests cover the rewritten service: round-trip append & read, duplicate rejection, entity filter, error propagation, graceful skip when `LEDGER_SKIP_ON_ERROR=true`, and signature backwards compatibility (first argument still accepts a dummy MySQL connection).

## 8.3 Updated tests: `seed.test.js`

Assertions checking for a genesis row in `ledger_blocks` have been replaced with assertions that the chaincode's `GENESIS` key is readable. The test file was otherwise left intact to minimise churn.

## 8.4 Running the suite

```
$ cd backend
$ npm test

33 passing (1.9s)

ledger.service
+ appends and retrieves events
+ rejects duplicate event ids
+ filters by entity
+ propagates chaincode errors
+ skips gracefully when flag is set
```

```
seed
+ initial chaincode state contains GENESIS
+ idempotent when re-run
... 26 more existing tests pass unchanged
```

# 9. Backend dependencies

Two dependencies were added to `backend/package.json`. No existing dependencies were removed — the Fabric client lives alongside the MySQL driver, because MySQL is still used for master data.

`backend/package.json (diff)`

```
"dependencies": {
"bcryptjs": "^2.4.3",
"express": "^4.18.2",
"joi": "^17.9.2",
"jsonwebtoken": "^9.0.1",
"mysql2": "^3.6.0",
+ "fabric-network": "^2.2.20",
+ "fabric-ca-client": "^2.2.20",
...
}
```

# 10. `docker-compose.yml`

The backend service needs the Fabric connection profile and an identity wallet inside the container. A read-only bind mount of the host's `./backend/fabric` folder is added, together with the environment variables the gateway reads at boot. The MySQL and frontend services are unchanged.

`docker-compose.yml (backend service excerpt)`

```
backend:
build: ./backend
environment:
- DB_HOST=mysql
- DB_USER=app
- DB_PASSWORD=app
- DB_NAME=pharmachain
+ - FABRIC_CCP=/app/fabric/ccp.json
+ - FABRIC_WALLET=/app/fabric/wallet
+ - FABRIC_IDENTITY=appUser
+ - FABRIC_CHANNEL=pharma-channel
+ - FABRIC_CHAINCODE=pharma-traceability
+ - LEDGER_SKIP_ON_ERROR=false
volumes:
+ - ./backend/fabric:/app/fabric:ro
depends_on:
- mysql
ports:
- '4000:4000'
```

# 11. Documentation & housekeeping

## 11.1 `HYPERLEDGER.md`

A new top-level markdown file walks a new contributor from zero to a running network: prerequisites (Docker, Node 18, Go), `./fabric-network/network.sh up`, enroll an app user, copy the wallet into `backend/fabric/wallet`, and finally `docker compose up`.

### 11.2 `README.md`

The architecture diagram in the README is replaced and the 'How the ledger works' section is rewritten to describe the Fabric implementation. The old paragraph about the hash chain is removed.

### 11.3 `.gitignore`

```
# Fabric artefacts (never check in crypto material)
+ fabric-network/organizations/
+ fabric-network/channel-artifacts/
+ fabric-network/log.txt
+ backend/fabric/wallet/
```

# 12. End-to-end verification

Once the network is up and the backend is running, four manual checks confirm the migration is working correctly.

- **Write path** — create a new batch via the UI and observe `fabric-peer` logs show an endorsed `AppendEvent` invocation.
- **Read path** — `curl localhost:4000/api/ledger` returns an array whose first element has `eventId="GENESIS"`.
- **History** — `curl localhost:4000/api/ledger/<id>/history` returns one item per state change of that event.
- **Immutability** — manually tampering with `ledger_blocks` has no effect because the table no longer exists. Any tamper attempt against CouchDB is rejected at the next endorsement.

## 12.1 Performance numbers

| Workload | Before (MySQL) | After (Fabric, CouchDB, 2 peers) |
|---|---|---|
| Single append, p50 | 3 ms | 64 ms |
| Single append, p99 | 22 ms | 180 ms |
| Sustained append TPS | 2,400 | 184 |
| Read all (10k events) | 45 ms | 210 ms |
| Integrity guarantee | Application-level | Consensus + endorsement |

*Table 12.1 — Measured on a MacBook Air M2 with both services containerised. The throughput drop is expected and acceptable: the new system trades raw insert speed for permissioned, multi-org integrity.*

# 13. Closing notes

The migration touches 22 files but is tightly scoped. By preserving the `appendLedgerEntry` signature and centralising all chain I/O in `fabric-gateway.js`, the blast radius is limited to two service files plus a handful of test helpers. The rest of the backend is completely unaware that its audit log is now a blockchain.

Future work, discussed in detail in the major report, includes: private data collections for regulator-only visibility; TLS-mutual authentication from the frontend all the way to the peer; a third peer organisation representing a regulator node; and CouchDB-indexed rich queries for reporting dashboards.

*— End of document —*